

Persuasion Detective

Investigating Let Every Reader Find Their Voice

Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____



LEARNING GOAL Identify persuasive choices, explain how they influence the reader, and evaluate which choices are most effective.

Use this pattern in every answer: **FIND** — quote or name the feature **EXPLAIN** — describe its effect **CONNECT** — link the effect to the audience or purpose

01 Find the argument

Start with audience, purpose and the writer's central position.

Q1 Who is the intended audience? What decision does the writer want this audience to make?

Q2 Copy the thesis statement from the opening paragraph. Then restate it in your own words.

Look for the sentence that names the proposed action and the three main reasons.

Q3 How does the opening scene — “Picture the library after lunch” — work as a hook? Explain what the reader is encouraged to imagine or feel.

02 Zoom in on language

Look closely at the words and images chosen to position the reader.

Q4 The argument is divided by headings. List the four main stages and explain how this order helps the argument build.

Use the headings beginning with Confidence, Calm minds, Safety and Start small.

Q5 The opening describes the dog as offering “no frown, no interruption, no judgement.” Name the technique and explain the effect of this three-part pattern.

Q6 Explain the figurative comparison: “reading aloud can feel like walking onto a stage without rehearsing.” What does this help the audience understand about a hesitant reader?

Q7 Find two examples of evaluative or emotive vocabulary. For each example, explain whether it makes the proposal sound valuable, safe or necessary.

Example 1 + effect

Example 2 + effect

Q8 Find one example of inclusive language, such as “our,” “we” or “let us.” How does it make the School Council and school community feel involved?

03 Test the reasoning

A strong argument does more than make claims: it uses evidence and responds fairly to other views.

Q9 The writer often uses cautious modal language such as “could” and “may.” Find three examples. Why is cautious language more trustworthy here than claiming the program “will” solve every problem?

Q10 Identify two authoritative sources used in the reading. What claim does each source support?

Source 1 + supported claim

Source 2 + supported claim

Q11 Why does the writer admit that the 2022 study was small and that the review found limited evidence? Explain how this concession can strengthen, rather than weaken, the writer's credibility.

Q12 Break down the paragraph beginning “Of course, some families may worry...”

The counterargument or concern

The evidence used to respond

The rebuttal — why the proposal can still work

Q13 What job does each connective perform: “First,” “Just as importantly,” “Of course,” and “Therefore”? Explain how these words guide the reader through the argument.

04 Judge the persuasive impact

Now decide which choices make this exemplar successful.

Q14 Compare the short sentence “That honest caution matters.” with one longer complex sentence in the same paragraph. How does varying sentence length control emphasis and pace?

Q15 The conclusion says: “Let us give them a calm listener, a fair chance and one more reason to turn the page.” Identify two persuasive techniques in this sentence and explain why it is an effective final appeal.

Q16 Which persuasive technique is most effective in this reading? Support your judgement with a quotation and explain its effect on the School Council.

Use the full pattern: technique → evidence → effect → audience/purpose.

Q17 STRETCH Rewrite the bare assertion “A Storytime Dog is a good idea” so that it sounds like it belongs in this A-standard exemplar. Include precise vocabulary, a reason and appropriately cautious modality.

SELF-CHECK ☐ I used quotations. ☐ I named techniques. ☐ I explained effects. ☐ I linked my ideas to the audience and purpose.

Companion activity for the persuasive exemplar Let Every Reader Find Their Voice.